STARWEAVER®

Hands-On-Learning: Create and Present a Cyber Risk Heat Map

Scenario

Your organization has identified five cyber risks affecting different business units. Leadership needs a visual summary to quickly understand which risks require immediate attention and what actions are recommended. In this hands-on activity, you will build a risk heat map and present your findings in a simple, executive-friendly format.

Instructions

1 Prepare Your Risk Data

Open ClickUp, Excel, or Miro. Use the following sample risks or real ones from your own environment:

- Phishing attack on employee inbox
- Unpatched web server vulnerability
- Misconfigured admin portal
- Lack of endpoint protection
- Third-party vendor exposure

2 Score the Risks

For each risk, assign:

- Likelihood (scale of 1–5)
- Impact (scale of 1–5)

Example:

Phishing attack → Likelihood: 4, Impact: 3

3 Create a Heat Map

Using ClickUp, Miro, or Excel:

- Build a 5x5 grid (Likelihood vs. Impact)
- Place each risk in the appropriate cell
- Apply color coding:
  - Red = Critical
  - Orange = High
  - Yellow = Medium

Green = Low

4 Analyze Your Findings

Answer these questions:

- Which risks are in the red zone?
- Which can be accepted or monitored?
- What’s the top recommended action?

5 Create a One-Slide Executive Summary

Open PowerPoint and include:

- A snapshot of the heat map
- 2–3 bullet points summarizing critical risks
- One clear recommendation (e.g., “Prioritize patching the web server this quarter”)

6 Optional: Add Ownership Tags

If using ClickUp or Miro, tag each risk with an owner or responsible team.

This activity helps you bridge technical analysis with business communication. By the end, you'll be able to turn data into visuals — and visuals into decisions.

Instructions for Documenting and Sharing the Project for Peer Review

Document the Project

- Use a word processor (e.g., Word or Google Docs) to compile all materials into a single project report.
- Ensure clarity, structure, and that each required section is present.
- Edit for professionalism and business-appropriate tone.

Share the Project

- Save your full report and the PowerPoint slide as PDFs.
- Upload both files to the Peer Review area in the course platform.
- In your submission post, include a 2–3 sentence description of what you learned and what your report includes.

Peer Review

- Read at least two peer submissions.
- Provide constructive, respectful feedback on clarity, logic, visual effectiveness, and actionability.

By completing this project, you'll walk through the full cyber risk management process—from identification to executive communication. You'll reinforce your ability to use structured tools and techniques that translate technical risk into strategic action.